



Smooth Scanning Tips

- **Selecting scanning area:** Always preview the document and select just the area to be scanned, instead of scanning the full document. This will reduce the scanning time as well as the file size, especially when scanning at high resolutions.
- **Resist scanning at high resolutions:** If you intend to scan your documents only to view them onscreen, scanning at a resolution between 100-150 dpi is enough as monitors can only display 72 dots per inch (dpi). Scanning documents at higher resolutions will only result in a larger file size. If you are scanning a document for faxing or OCR-ing, 200-300 dpi is sufficient and for printing photos, 300-600 dpi is fine. For photo scanning, keep the setting at the maximum colour depth that your scanner supports.
- **Use Descreen:** When you scan content from magazines or newspapers, you will notice a lot of moiré (converging and diverging lines) on the scanned image. The best way to reduce this pattern is to use the Descreen option in the scanner software. If your scanner software does not have a Descreen option, you can use an image editing software.
- **Image format:** Select an image format depending on where you will be using the image. If you will be using it for the Web or for animation, save it in JPEG or GIF—these compressed formats save a lot of hard disk space. On the other hand, if you are scanning the image for print, TIFF is the best format as it compresses the image without loss in image quality.
- **Correct ghost images:** A ghost image occurs when the scanner picks up images from the back of the page. This can usually be corrected by changing the darkness and contrast settings. Experiment to find the best settings for your scanner. Another simple way to correct this is to place a thick white paper over the document being scanned.
- **Adjust brightness, contrast and sharpness:** Many a times the scanned image turns out to be dull. This can be easily fixed through the TWAIN driver (if your scanner supports it) or through the image editing software where you can adjust the contrast and brightness levels.

1/2 page V. AD

In the greyscale tonal deviation test, there are 22 distinctly shaded bars. The last four bars have very minor differences in shade, and it is a big feat for a scanner to pick up these differences. Hence, a score of 18 should be considered quite acceptable, whereas a score of 20 and above would be exceptional. In the colour tonal deviation test, a combined weighted score of about 4 points out of 10 for the dark, mid and light zones should be considered acceptable. The variations in colour in the dark and the mid zones are relatively easy to achieve but most scanners cannot pick up the variations in the light coloured areas. Here, if a scanner scores more than 5 points, it means that it has decent capabilities to capture tonal variations. It is rare to find a scanner that can manage all three zones without trouble—such scanners will achieve a combined weighted score of over 6 points.

In the greyscale tonal deviation test, all the scanners in the budget segment detected at least 18 of the 22 shades. The Microtek ScanMaker 3800 detected 21 bars. No other scanner in this category could match that score, but the Agfa SnapScan 310P, Canon CanoScan N640P and the Microtek ScanMaker 3630 did manage to detect 20 bars each. In the colour deviation test, most budget scanners crossed 4 points. Only the Canon CanoScan N640P and